

Billing Policy

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy describes how Harbor & Pine Outfitters issues invoices, collects payment, and processes refunds for consumer orders. It also defines how invoice questions received by email are answered.

2. Invoices

2.1 Issuance

An invoice is issued for every order at the time the order is placed. Each invoice references exactly one order and carries a unique identifier in the form INV-YYYY-NNNN.

2.2 Invoice contents

Every invoice records:

- the order it relates to and the customer it was issued to;
- the subtotal, shipping, tax, and total amount;
- the amount paid, the amount refunded, and the amount still due;
- the issue date and the payment due date.

2.3 Currency and tax

All amounts are in US dollars (USD). Sales tax is applied at 8% of the order subtotal. Shipping is free for orders with a subtotal of 150 USD or more and a flat 7.95 USD otherwise.

3. Payment Terms

Payment is due within 14 days of the invoice issue date. Accepted payment methods are credit card, PayPal, and bank transfer.

4. Invoice Statuses

An invoice carries exactly one of the following statuses:

Status Meaning

unpaid Issued, not yet paid, and not past its due date.

paid Paid in full; nothing is outstanding.

partially_paid Part of the balance has been paid; a balance remains due.

overdue Unpaid after the due date has passed.

refunded Paid in full and then fully refunded.

voided Cancelled before payment; nothing is owed.

5. Answering Invoice Questions

When a customer asks about an invoice, the answer must be grounded in the stored invoice record. Common questions and how to answer them:

- "How much do I owe?" - Report the amountDue and the due date.
- "Has my payment gone through?" - Report the status and, if paid, the paid date.
- "Why was I charged this amount?" - Break down the subtotal, shipping, and tax.
- "Is this invoice overdue?" - An invoice is overdue only when its status is overdue.

If the invoice referenced by the customer cannot be located, or the question concerns a dispute or a chargeback, the case is escalated to a human agent under the Customer Service Policy.

6. Refunds

6.1 When a refund is issued

A refund is issued when:

- an order is cancelled after payment has been captured;
- an approved damaged-item claim is resolved with a refund rather than a replacement;
- an undamaged item is returned within the 30-day return window.

6.2 How refunds are processed

Refunds are returned to the original payment method. A full refund sets the invoice

status to refunded, records the refunded amount, and leaves nothing due. Refunds are normally processed within 5 to 10 business days.

7. Overdue Accounts

A first reminder is sent when an invoice becomes overdue. Repeated non-payment is handled by Finance and is outside the scope of automated email responses.

8. Disputes

Billing disputes, chargebacks, and requests for goodwill adjustments are not resolved automatically. These are always escalated to a human agent.